

WF

CHRISTMAS 2026 EDITION

WILEY FOX TRAVEL
FAMILIES AND SOLO TRAVELLERS

THE WILEY FOX GUIDE TO

Nuremberg

For families & solo travellers

WILEY FOX RATING • LOW

4

OUT OF 5 • POLICE DATA JAN 2025 TO DEC 2025

CREATOR FEELING 4/5 • SAFE AND WALKABLE, BUT VERY CROWDED AT THE MARKET

27 Nov - 24 Dec

CHRISTKINDLESMARKT 2026

Daily 10:00-21:00, opened by the Christkind at 17:30 on 27 November (christkindlesmarkt.de, Sept 2026).

€5

MUG DEPOSIT AT THE 2025 MARKET

Hand the mug back for a refund or keep it as a souvenir - check this year's amount at the stall.

71

CREATORS • 83 VIDEOS

Paraphrased and credited, cross-checked with police figures.

Nuremberg is a compact, walkable city: the walled old town takes about 20 minutes to cross, the U-Bahn runs straight from the airport to the Hauptbahnhof, and almost every sight sits inside or just outside the medieval walls. The river Pegnitz splits the old town in two: the Lorenz side by the station, and the Sebald side with the Hauptmarkt and the hill up to the Imperial Castle. Creators disagree on how long you need, from 24 hours to three days; two is the common answer.

At Christmas the Hauptmarkt becomes the Christkindlesmarkt, one of the oldest and most famous Christmas markets in Germany, with a separate children's market next door and smaller markets around the old town. For families it is a gentle city: a children's Christmas market with carousels and biscuit baking, a toy museum and a railway museum, and a castle with a 50-metre well that children can pour water into. The weight of history is here too - the Nazi Party Rally Grounds and the courtroom of the Nuremberg Trials are here too, and creators urge a visit.

For solo travellers it is an easy, low-crime city by police figures, and creators found it safe to walk. The risks are ordinary ones - dense market crowds, cold dark evenings from about 4pm, and a busy, sometimes rough area around the main station. This guide shows you where, using the latest police and city reports.

WF

Germany doesn't publish street-level crime data, so before you book, check your hotel's street against the map in this guide and any community reports on Wiley Fox - and ask the hotel which side of the station it's on.

Fast facts

CURRENCY	Euro (EUR) - cards are widely taken, but some market stalls are cash only, so carry notes and coins
LANGUAGE	German - castle and rally-grounds information boards are also in English
TIME ZONE	Central European Time (UTC+1, UTC+2 in summer) - one hour ahead of the UK
PLUG	Type C and F, 230V - UK plugs need an adaptor
EMERGENCY	110 police · 112 fire & ambulance (free from any phone)
ENTRY	UK passport must be under 10 years old on arrival and valid 3+ months after you leave the Schengen area; visa-free for up to 90 days in any 180 (gov.uk, Sept 2026)
TIPPING	About 5-10%, or round up - tell the server the total you want to pay
BEST TIME	Late November to Christmas Eve for the market (the busiest time); April-May and September-October are quieter and cheaper

THE FESTIVE SEASON

Christmas in Nuremberg

The Christkindlesmarkt is the reason most people come to Nuremberg: rows of red-and-white stalls on the Hauptmarkt below the Frauenkirche, opened each year by the Christkind and visited by around two million people. In 2026 it runs from 27 November to 24 December. It is genuinely crowded – creators agree there's no truly quiet time – but by police figures it is calm, with about a dozen pickpocket thefts in the whole 2024 season and no violent offences in 2024 or 2025.

Christmas markets



Christkindlesmarkt

HAUPTMARKT • 27 NOV - 24 DEC 2026, DAILY 10:00-21:00 • GREAT FOR KIDS

One of Germany's oldest and most famous Christmas markets – counts range from 147 stalls (Prowalk Tours, 2025) to around 200. Look for Lebkuchen, Drei im Weggla, handmade wooden toys and Zwetschgenmännle, the prune figures that are for decoration, not eating. Choirs sing on Advent evenings, and a balcony Glühwein bar with a heater looks over the square (cash only). Creators split: most found it magical, but MY Travel BF found the layout repetitive and oddly quiet, and others found fewer places to sit than in Munich.

Crowds: Packed on Saturday evenings and weekend afternoons; Here's Good found both crowded and say there's no quiet time. Early mornings and weekday afternoons are calmer, and one creator found a Tuesday night in November comfortable.

Via [Prowalk Tours](#), [Here's Good](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#), [Ty & Kena](#), [Prime Travel Time](#), [MY Travel BF](#), [Britt and Mitch Worldwide](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [Tourist Walk Experience](#), [Erin Parro – The Scenic Route Traveler](#)

Free entry · Glühwein about €5 + €5 mug deposit (2025)



Photo: Lothar Weber · CC BY-SA 4.0



Kinderweihnacht (children's Christmas market)

HANS-SACHS-PLATZ · ALONGSIDE THE MAIN MARKET - CHECK THE OFFICIAL SITE · GREAT FOR KIDS

The families' favourite: a nostalgic double-decker carousel, a mini Ferris wheel and a little steam train, plus cabins for decorating biscuits, pouring candles and painting wooden toys, and a post office for letters to the Christkind. Kinderpunsch comes in its own mug (€5 deposit in 2023). The Christkind visits Tuesday to Friday at 14:30.

Crowds: Calmer than the main market and easy with children in the morning; one family could hardly move there on a busy afternoon and gave up on the Ferris wheel.

Via [Prowalk Tours](#), [Tourist Walk Experience](#), [Andrew & Kait](#), [Tu Guía de Viajes](#), [Probably Lost](#), [Travels of Sarah Fay](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#), [Chasing Footprints](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Photo: DALIBRI · CC BY-SA 4.0



Market of the Sister Cities

RATHAUSPLATZ · 27 NOV - 23 DEC 2026 · GREAT FOR KIDS

Stalls from around 20 of Nuremberg's partner cities (Prowalk Tours counted 22) - from Glasgow and Nice to Kharkiv and Prague - selling food and crafts you won't find on the main square: samosas, baklava, chai, trdelník chimney cakes. Proceeds are said to go to good causes in the partner cities.

Crowds: Laid out like a small labyrinth; busy in the evenings like the main market.

Via [Prowalk Tours](#), [Andrew & Kait](#), [Chris and Sara](#), [Tu Guía de Viajes](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [Probably Lost](#)

Free entry

DETAILS

Winter Village

JAKOBSPLATZ • CHRISTMAS SEASON - CHECK THE OFFICIAL SITE • GREAT FOR KIDS



Up for a Walk? found wooden chalets, mulled wine and bratwurst on Jakobsplatz, between the St. Jakob and St. Elisabeth churches - a quieter evening stop. Tourist Walk Experience describes a Winter Village with a big red-and-gold Ferris wheel and fairground rides, more funfair than historic market. Check what's on this year.

Crowds: Quieter than the Hauptmarkt.

Via [Up for a Walk?](#), [Prowalk Tours](#), [Tourist Walk Experience](#)

Free entry

DETAILS

Weihnachten im Handwerkerhof

BY THE KÖNIGSTOR • CHRISTMAS SEASON - CHECK OPENING DAYS • GREAT FOR KIDS



The craftsmen's courtyard by the station turns into its own small Christmas market with lights, crafts, gingerbread and chocolate. Así es el mundo calls it the best Christmas atmosphere in the city.

Crowds: Busiest at Christmas; handy as a first or last stop by the station.

Via [Walking Alice](#), [A Festival Called Life](#), [Así es el mundo](#), [Jazmin Angelique](#), [Tourist Walk Experience](#), [Up for a Walk?](#)

Free entry

DETAILS

Original Regional Market

OLD TOWN, BY THE MAIN MARKET • ALONGSIDE THE MAIN MARKET



A tiny section of half a dozen to a dozen stalls with handmade goods from Franconia and the Upper Palatinate - soap, beeswax candles and crafts. Worth seeking out.

Crowds: Small, so it fills quickly at peak times.

Via [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [Prowalk Tours](#), [MY Travel BF](#)

Free entry

DETAILS

Lights, rinks and festive sights

The Christkind's opening prologue

FRAUENKIRCHE BALCONY, HAUPTMARKT • 27 NOV 2026, 17:30 • GREAT FOR KIDS



The market opens with the Christkind reciting her prologue from the Frauenkirche gallery, with fanfares and a children's choir - a ceremony DW Travel says is broadcast worldwide. A new Christkind is chosen every two years.

Crowds: The Hauptmarkt is packed. Arrive well before 17:30 and agree a meeting point before you go in.

Via [BR24](#), [grizzly2000](#), [DW Travel](#), [Lady Walks The Globe](#), [Chris and Sara](#)

Free

DETAILS

Meeting the Christkind

KINDERWEIHNACHT & HAUPTMARKT • TUESDAY TO FRIDAY, 14:30 AT THE
KINDERWEIHNACHT • GREAT FOR KIDS



The Christkind makes around 170 appearances before Christmas, handing out Lebkuchen, taking photos, collecting wish lists and inviting children on to the carousel for free.

Crowds: Children crowd around her at stage events; one creator struggled to spot her in the crowd.

Via [BR24](#), [tagesschau](#), [Prowalk Tours](#), [DW Travel](#), [Andrew & Kait](#)

Free

DETAILS

Feuerzangenbowle by the river

OLD TOWN, BY THE PEGNITZ • DURING THE MARKET



Red wine and rum punch with a flaming rum-soaked sugar cone melted into it, served from what creators describe as the world's largest Feuerzangenbowle cauldron. It's strong and sweet - some loved it, others found it too sweet. Glühwein with rum or amaretto is for over-18s; children get alcohol-free Kinderpunsch.

Crowds: Some stands use a mug token that must go back to the same stand.

Via [MY Travel BF](#), [Here's Good](#), [Travels of Sarah Fay](#), [Kara and Nate](#), [Andrew & Kait](#), [DW Euromaxx](#), [Prowalk Tours](#)

€6 + €5 deposit (Here's Good) or €7 + €3 (MY Travel BF), 2025

Lebkuchen, fresh from the oven

HAUPTMARKT AND OLD TOWN • ALL SEASON • GREAT FOR KIDS



Nuremberg Lebkuchen is soft and chewy on a thin wafer; the Elisen kind is mostly nuts with very little flour. Fresh ones were €5.50 at a stall in 2025, and the fresh-baked Lebkuchen shops had closed by 7pm when one creator went, so buy earlier. Lebkuchen Schmidt and Wicklein are the classic names; gingerbread hearts are for wearing, not eating.

Crowds: Queues at the fresh-baked stalls in the evening.

Via [Here's Good](#), [Prime Travel Time](#), [Chris and Sara](#), [Where Are We?!](#), [Tourist Walk Tours](#), [DW Food](#), [DW Euromaxx](#), [Tu Guía de Viajes](#)

About €5-5.50 each (2024-25)

The castle view over the market

KAISERBURG • CASTLE OCT-MAR 10:00-16:00; CLOSED 24, 25 & 31 DEC • GREAT FOR KIDS



About a 10-minute walk up from the market, the castle wall gives a free view over the rooftops and the market below. It was 1°C when Britt and Mitch went, so wrap up.

Crowds: Go by early afternoon - it's dark before 4pm.

Via [Britt and Mitch Worldwide](#), [Kara and Nate](#), [MY Travel BF](#)

View free

DETAILS

The market from above

ST. LORENZ & FRAUENKIRCHE • CHECK AVAILABILITY



In 2024 Britt and Mitch climbed St. Lorenz late at night to look down on the market, booked a day ahead; in 2025 Walking Alice queued about 30 minutes for the Frauenkirche viewing platform over the square. Ask at the churches whether it's offered this year.

Crowds: Limited places - book or queue.

Via [Britt and Mitch Worldwide](#), [Walking Alice](#)

Check on the day

Lights, angels & a post coach

KÖNIGSTRASSE & OLD TOWN • EVENINGS, ALL SEASON • GREAT FOR KIDS



Thousands of lights, angels and stars hang over the old-town streets, and stalls stretch along Königstraße to St. Lorenz. Look out for a yellow horse-drawn post coach circling the market, and a nativity barn with a camel, donkey and llama.

Crowds: Königstraße is busy with shoppers; side streets are calmer.

Via [WonderJourneys](#), [Up for a Walk?](#), [Lady Walks The Globe](#), [BR24](#), [Irina Dee](#)

Free

Staying safe in the Christmas crowds

Crowds and timing

Pickpockets: low numbers, same habits

The Hauptmarkt is body-to-body on weekend afternoons, Saturday evenings and the opening night. Mornings and weekday afternoons are easier, and the streets just outside stay quiet. Nuremberg police advise extra care in any crush.

Via [Here's Good](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#), [Ty & Kena](#), [Walking Alice](#), [Jm Banquicio](#)

Police counted only about a dozen pickpocket thefts at the whole 2024 market and barely double figures in 2025, and plain-clothes officers work the crowds. Their advice still stands: valuables split between closed inner pockets, bags zipped and in front or under your arm.

Via [Jm Banquicio](#)

Cash, deposits and coins

Carry euros - some stalls are cash only and cash-machine queues get long. Mugs carried a €5 deposit in 2025 and plates €2-2.50, so check the amount at the stall and keep your tokens. Market toilets cost €0.50-1, free for children in one creator's experience.

Via [Here's Good](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [Ty & Kena](#), [Prime Travel Time](#), [Jm Banquicio](#)

Cold, dark and nowhere to sit

It's dark by about 4pm and creators saw -1°C to 4°C in early December. There are few places to sit and no heated huts, so you'll eat and drink standing: wear warm layers and gloves - some stalls sell wool insoles if you underestimate the cold.

Via [Here's Good](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#), [Kara and Nate](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [Tu Guía de Viajes](#), [MY Travel BF](#), [Jm Banquicio](#)

Have a lost-child plan

Before you go in, agree a meeting point everyone can find - the Schöner Brunnen fountain on the corner of the Hauptmarkt is the obvious one. The children's market can get so crowded you can hardly move, and police reunited many temporarily missing people at the 2025 market. A Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child means anyone who finds them can reach you straight away.

Via [Chasing Footprints](#)

Leave the car - and the penknife

Police ask visitors not to drive in on busy weekends; illegally parked cars are towed. Knives are banned at large events, with random bag checks, and drones are banned over the market.

Via [Mita in Germany](#)

The 2026 market runs 27 November to 24 December, daily 10:00-21:00, with the Christkind's opening at 17:30 on 27 November (christkindlesmarkt.de); Prowalk Tours' 2025 video says it closes at 14:00 on Christmas Eve, so check before planning that day. The Sister Cities market ends on 23 December. Book hotels early - a solo creator found single rooms very expensive at Christmas and chose a hostel - and remember the castle is closed on 24, 25 and 31 December and shops close on Sundays.

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Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the market crowd, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT THE DATA AND THE CREATORS SAY

*How it feels, and what the numbers show**The data*

Nuremberg is a low-crime city for its size. Police recorded 7,028 offences per 100,000 residents in 2025, close to the five-year average, and still rate that as low among comparable big cities; in the 2024 national comparison it was the second-safest German city of over 200,000 people. Robberies fell by a fifth in 2025. The Christmas market is calm by police standards: about a dozen pickpocket thefts across the whole 2024 season and no violent offences in 2024 or 2025. The one area both police and the city single out is around the Hauptbahnhof, especially its south side. This rating is for the city as a whole, not street by street: German police do not publish street-level crime data.

The creators

Creators describe Nuremberg as clean, walkable and safe: Cleared 2 Travel calls it very safe, and Near From Home says the car-light old town makes everywhere feel safer. The complaint is crowds, not crime - the Christkindlesmarkt is packed at weekends and after dark. One solo creator (Bule Barbie) felt more nervous walking alone than at home, even on a busy Saturday evening, and another (Jm Banquicio) was told by other travellers to wear her bags at the front; she had no problems. One budget traveller found a red-light street beside the city wall near his hostel.

What the official figures say

Figures are for the whole city for calendar year 2025, from the Nuremberg police's Sicherheitsbericht 2025, plus police press releases on the Christkindlesmarkt in 2024 and 2025. No street or district figures are published, and there is no city figure for pickpocketing. Rates are per resident, so millions of visitors and commuters push them up. Some categories rose in 2025: sexual offences were up 14%, mainly harassment and mostly in public places. Around the Hauptbahnhof police recorded 1,526 offences in 2025 (1,611 in 2024), which they call low in the long term; almost half were drug offences found by police checks, and offences inside the station are counted separately by federal

police. The City of Nuremberg's own 2025 report has no crime counts and is more negative in tone: it describes a clearly tense situation on the station's south side (Südstadtpark), with open drug dealing, and nuisance on the north side and along the Frauentorgraben. Knife and cannabis ban zones and an extended alcohol ban zone now apply around the station.

7,028

RECORDED OFFENCES PER 100,000 RESIDENTS IN 2025

Up 1.8% on 2024 and near the five-year average. Police still call it low for a big city; Nuremberg was 2nd safest German city over 200,000 people in the 2024 BKA comparison.

About a dozen

PICKPOCKET THEFTS AT THE WHOLE 2024 CHRISTKINDLESMARKT

And no violent offences at all, according to Nuremberg police (November 2025).

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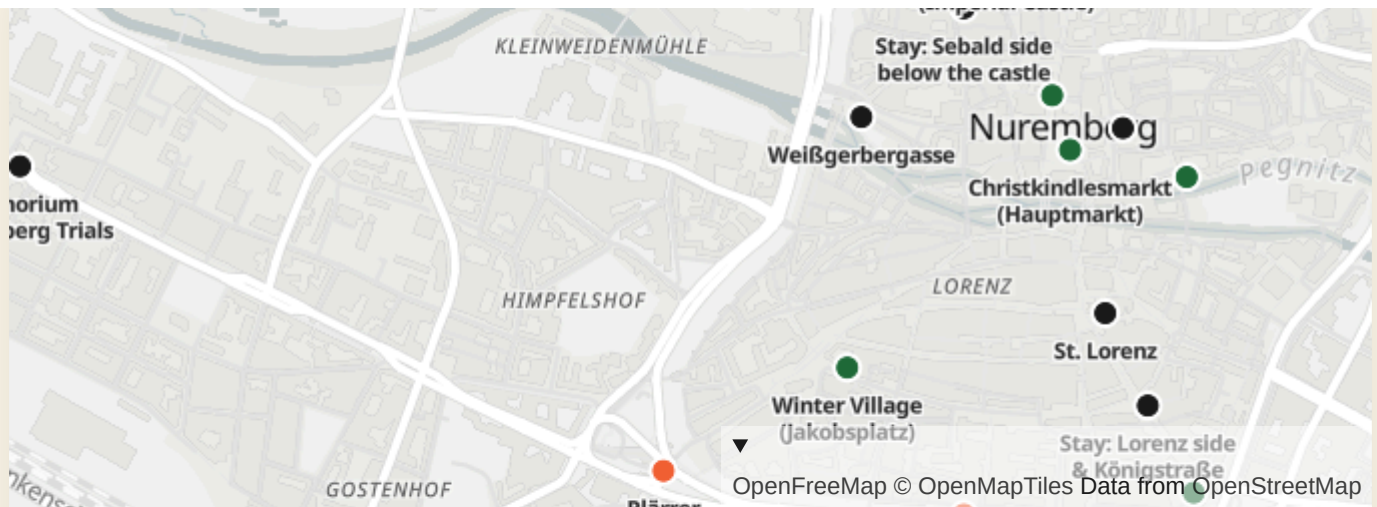
VIOLENT OFFENCES AT THE 2025 MARKET

Police called the 2025 market 'calm and peaceful', with handbag and pickpocket thefts barely into double figures (24 December 2025).

Map: markets, sights and places to take care

Germany doesn't publish street-level crime data, so this map shows the markets and sights in this guide and the areas official reports and creators flag.





Crime figures: Polizeipräsidium Mittelfranken, Sicherheitsbericht 2025 (PKS) · [Open the Wiley Fox map](#)

Areas to take extra care

None of these are no-go areas. Know the pattern, and plan your timing and your route home.

● Hauptbahnhof - south side (Südstadtpark)

TAKE MOST CARE: EVENINGS AND AFTER DARK

The City of Nuremberg's 2025 report describes a clearly tense situation on the south side of the main station and the Südstadtpark, with open drug dealing and disputes between groups; police have added video cameras and there is a strong police presence. Police figures for the whole station area are lower than you might expect - 1,526 offences in 2025, down on 2024 and mostly drug offences found by police checks. Knife, cannabis and alcohol ban zones apply around the station. Travellers rarely need the south side: use the old-town exits.

Source: Polizeipräsidium Mittelfranken / Stadt Nürnberg reports

● Frauentorgraben, Frauentormauer & the station's north side

TAKE MOST CARE: LATE EVENING AND NIGHT

One creator staying at a hostel by the southern city wall found a red-light street on the other side of the wall, visible even in the morning, and advises avoiding it; the city's 2025 report names the Frauentormauer for prostitution but says it caused no public-space problems in 2025. The same report does flag the Frauentorgraben, the road outside the wall, for late-night disorder from partying crowds, drug dealing near the Jakobstor and poor lighting, plus problems around the Königstorpassage by the station, which it says have eased. Walk in through the Frauentor and keep to the lit old-town streets.

● Plärrer

TAKE MOST CARE: EVENINGS

A major transport hub on the western edge of the old town. The city's report calls it a long-standing focus of police measures for nuisance and drug use, especially in the underground concourse, though the city's outreach team could not confirm most complaints. Fine to change trains here; no reason to linger.

Source: Polizeipräsidium Mittelfranken / Stadt Nürnberg reports

● Hauptmarkt during the market

TAKE MOST CARE: WEEKENDS, EVENINGS AND THE OPENING NIGHT

The square is packed at weekends and after dark, and creators say there's no truly quiet time. Police recorded only about a dozen pickpocket thefts in the whole 2024 season, but they still send plain-clothes officers against pickpockets and advise keeping valuables in closed inner pockets and bags in front. Go in the morning or on a weekday.

Via [Here's Good](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#), [Tu Guía de Viajes](#), [Walking Alice](#), [Andrew & Kait](#)

● Castle hill & the cobbles

TAKE MOST CARE: WET OR ICY DAYS, AND AFTER DARK

The walk up to the Kaiserburg is very steep, with a choice of steps or a long slope, and the old town is cobbled throughout. Creators found it slow going with a one-year-old walking and tiring for a solo walker. Wear good shoes, allow extra time with a pushchair, and take care on the way down in the dark.

Via [Apure Gurial](#), [Ageless Restyling](#), [Chasing Footprints](#), [iwannaTV](#), [MY Travel BF](#)

● Nazi Party Rally Grounds

TAKE MOST CARE: RAIN, MATCH DAYS AND LATE AFTERNOON

The site is huge, exposed and mostly empty, with long walks between the Documentation Centre, the Zeppelinfeld and the Great Road. Creators found it unpleasant in the rain, and on a football match day next door the area was crowded and car parks were full. Go in daylight, wear comfortable shoes, and check the tram times back.

Via [The Iron Armenian aka G.I. Haigs](#), [Munich Tour Tips TV](#), [Cycle Baba](#), [The History Underground](#)

Walking back after the market closes? Save your hotel on Wiley Fox, stick to the lit main streets through the old town and keep SOS one tap away.

Scams and tricks creators keep seeing

Petitions and 'free' gifts

A Germany-wide warning: people with clipboards, 'free' flowers or bracelets in tourist areas and on public transport, who then ask for a donation. Smile, say 'Nein, danke' and keep walking.

Via [ZeroZeroFourNine](#)

Fake ticket inspectors

Real inspectors carry ID, and a creator who covers German scams says fines are never taken in cash on the spot. If someone demands cash, ask for ID or walk away.

Via [ZeroZeroFourNine](#)

Deposits on everything

Not a scam, but it catches people out: drinks come with a mug deposit (€5 in 2025), and plates, cups and forks carry €1-2.50 each. Keep the token and return things to get it back. One Feuerzangenbowle stand's mug had to go back to the same stand.

Via [DW Euromaxx](#), [Here's Good](#), [Jm Banquicio](#), [Andrew & Kait](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#)

Cash-only stalls and broken cash machines

Many stalls take cards, but not all - including a balcony Glühwein bar and a hot chocolate stall. Creators queued at cash machines or walked to three banks before one worked. Bring euros with you.

Via [Here's Good](#), [Ty & Kena](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#)

Tourist-trap tables

Don't eat at the first restaurant you see on a main square - look around first. For sausages, a sausage house just off the market charged €3.80 for three in a roll against about €4.50 at stalls (2025), and one old bratwurst house offered its cheap roll only until 6pm.

Via [Near From Home](#), [Here's Good](#), [Apure Guria!](#)

NEIGHBOURHOODS

Where to stay

Pick an area first, then a hotel. The old town is compact, so most bases are within a short walk of the markets.



Photo: Flocci Nivis · CC BY 4.0

Around the Hauptmarkt

CHRISTMAS MARKET • FIRST-TIMERS

The heart of everything: step out of the door into the Christkindlesmarkt, with the castle a 10-minute walk uphill. Several creators had rooms looking straight onto the square - 'you can't beat the view', say Devin & Z. Hotel Sax is right on the square. Book very early for December.

Via [Devin & Z](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#), [A Festival Called Life](#), [Cleared 2 Travel](#), [TripHunter](#)



Photo: Damir-zg · CC BY-SA 4.0

Sebald side, below the castle

SIGHTSEERS • COUPLES

The north of the old town, close to the castle, Weißgerbergasse, the Dürer House and the sunset crowd on the walls at Albrecht-Dürer-Platz. The catch is hills: steep cobbled lanes are hard work with luggage or a pushchair, and one creator's hotel had no lift to the third floor.

Via [Traveling Expats](#), [Easy German](#), [Ty & Kena](#), [Ageless Restyling](#), [Near From Home](#)



Photo: Flocci Nivis · CC BY 4.0

Lorenz side & Königstraße

Photo: Unknown authorUnknown author · Public domain

FAMILIES • EASY TRANSPORT

Between the station and the market along Königstraße, the main shopping street, with St. Lorenz church and the Lorenzkirche U-Bahn stop one stop from the Hauptbahnhof. At Christmas Königstraße is lit up and lined with stalls. The city's 2025 report rates the inner city 'stable' but notes some begging and rough sleeping on Königstraße and Breite Gasse.

Via [Jubaer Talukder](#), [Jayesh & Shreya](#), [Rocky Road 4K](#), [Up for a Walk?](#)

Near the Hauptbahnhof (old-town side)

TRAINS & AIRPORT • SHORT STAYS

The most convenient base if you arrive by train or on the U2 from the airport: the Handwerkerhof and the Frauentor gate into the old town are just across the road. Official reports flag the station surroundings, most strongly the south side (Südstadtpark), so pick a hotel facing the old town and walk in through the Frauentor rather than around the back of the station at night.

Via [Cleared 2 Travel](#), [Apure Gurial](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Travels & Magic Destinations](#) - [Orion Ember](#)

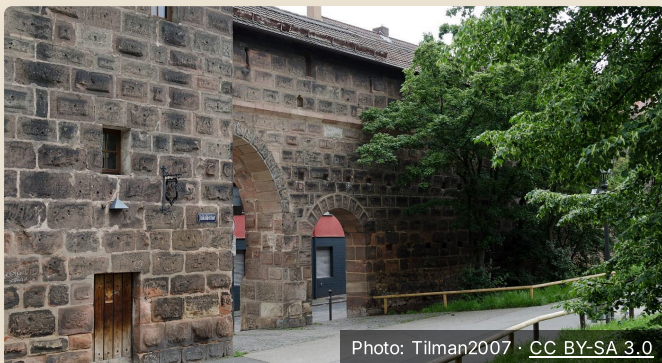


Photo: Tilman2007 · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)

Budget: hostels by the city wall

SOLO TRAVELLERS • BUDGET

Hostels along the southern city wall are five to ten minutes' walk from the station, and one solo creator chose a hostel dorm because single hotel rooms were very expensive at Christmas. Check the exact street before you book: one creator found a red-light street across the wall from his hostel, and the city's report flags the Frauentorgraben, outside the southern wall, for late-night disorder.

Via [Jm Banquicio](#), [Cleared 2 Travel](#), [Cycle Baba](#)

Hotels we'd start with

Wiley Fox may earn a small commission if you book through these links. Your price stays the same.

HAUPTMARKT · MARKET VIEWS

Hotel Sax

On or just off the Hauptmarkt - Cleared 2 Travel says some rooms overlook the Schöner Brunnen and the Frauenkirche and calls it moderately priced; TripHunter puts it about 100 m away and rated it the best-value budget choice (2022).

€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Cleared 2 Travel](#)

OPPOSITE THE HAUPTBAHNHOF · COMFORT

Le Méridien Grand Hotel Nuremberg

A five-star grand hotel open since 1897, opposite the main station - praised for comfortable beds and breakfast. Handy if you're arriving by train.

€€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Cleared 2 Travel](#)

BY THE CITY WALL, NEAR THE STATION ·
SOLO & BUDGET

Five Reasons Hotel & Hostel

Well-rated hostel with dorms and private rooms, 5-9 minutes' walk from the station. A solo creator's 4-bed dorm had privacy curtains, €1 lockers, a clean bathroom and a lounge bar (Dec 2025). The last stretch is cobbled - there's a smoother way round the block with a suitcase.

€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Jm Banquicio](#)

NEAR THE RALLY GROUNDS (2.7 KM OUT) ·
FAMILIES WITH A CAR

Ramada Park Hotel Nürnberg

Listed by TripHunter as a luxury option with an indoor pool, near the Congress Hall and rally grounds about 2.7 km from the centre (2022 video - check the current name and facilities).

€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [TripHunter](#)

Search all Nuremberg hotels

Compare live prices, then check the street on the Wiley Fox map before you book.

SEARCH BOOKING.COM

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Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the market crowd, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT CREATORS RATE

Ten things worth your time

Ranked by how often creators recommend them. Almost everything is inside or just outside the old town walls; in December, see the sights by daylight and save the markets for the evening.

Kaiserburg (Imperial Castle)

SEBALD SIDE • GREAT FOR KIDS

01

The city's landmark, on the hill above the old town. The courtyards, gardens and views are free; a ticket adds the Sinwell Tower and the 50-metre Deep Well, where a guide pours water in and it takes about five seconds to land - children are invited to try. Exhibition boards are in English as well as German. Steep walk up; best at sunset.

Via [Cleared 2 Travel](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Mita in Germany](#), [Easy German](#), [Britt and Mitch Worldwide](#), [Kara and Nate](#), [Ageless Restyling](#), [A Festival Called Life](#), [Near From Home](#)

Grounds free · full ticket about €9-10 (2025-26)

DETAILS

02



Photo: Robert von Oliva (naruciakk) · CC0

Weißgerbergasse

SEBALD SIDE • GREAT FOR KIDS

The tanners' lane - about 20 half-timbered houses that survived the war, now cafés and small shops. Often called the prettiest street in the city, so it gets crowded in the evenings, at weekends and at Christmas. Go early for photos.

Via [Easy German](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Rok Goes Around](#), [Mita in Germany](#), [Jazmin Angelique](#), [Brian and Carrie](#), [Jubaer Talukder](#), [Así es el mundo](#)

Free

DETAILS

03



Photo: Lothar Spurzem · [CC BY-SA 2.0 de](#)

Hauptmarkt, Schöner Brunnen & Frauenkirche

HAUPTMARKT • GREAT FOR KIDS

The main square and home of the Christmas market. Spin the brass ring in the railings of the Schöner Brunnen fountain for luck, and be under the Frauenkirche clock at noon, when its mechanical figures perform. The church is free to enter.

Via [Rok Goes Around](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Easy German](#), [iwannaTV](#), [Apure Guria!](#), [Laura Bronner](#), [Así es el mundo](#), [Prowalk Tours](#)

Free

DETAILS

04



Photo: KaterBegemot · [CC BY 3.0](#)

Documentation Centre & Rally Grounds

ZEPPELINFELD (SOUTH-EAST)

The Nazi Party Rally Grounds: the unfinished Congress Hall, the Zeppelin grandstand you can still walk on, and the Great Road, with a circular trail of boards in German and English. Creators call it chilling and sobering, and say it needs longer than a quick visit. The museum was renovating in 2023, with an interim exhibition.

Via [Cleared 2 Travel](#), [DW Travel](#), [Rok Goes Around](#), [The History Underground](#), [The Iron Armenian aka G.I. Haigs](#), [Bucket List Urban Adventures](#), [Munich Tour Tips TV](#), [ViaTravelers](#), [Así es el mundo](#)

Grounds free · museum €6 in 2023 (renovation) – check

DETAILS

Memorium Nuremberg Trials & Courtroom 600

PALACE OF JUSTICE (WEST)

05

The courtroom where the main war-crimes trial began in November 1945, with a museum on the top floor. Watch the short presentation in the courtroom first; an audio guide is included. Allow 1-1.5 hours.

Via [Laura Bronner](#), [Michele Venlee](#), [DW Travel](#), [Rok Goes Around](#), [Así es el mundo](#)

Paid

DETAILS

06



Photo: Schlaier · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)

The Pegnitz bridges

OLD TOWN · GREAT FOR KIDS

The covered wooden Henkersteg (Hangman's Bridge), the 1824 Kettensteg chain bridge and the view from the Maxbrücke across to the Weinstadel, best in late-afternoon sun. The Henkersteg was closed for building work until the end of October in 2025, so check it's open.

Via [Near From Home](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Apure Gurial](#), [One Way Ticket](#), [Así es el mundo](#)

Free

DETAILS

07



St. Lorenz

LORENZ SIDE • GREAT FOR KIDS

The great Gothic church on Königstraße, over 800 years old, with one of the world's largest organs and sometimes free organ concerts. Entry is free with a €2 donation asked. One couple found it closed to visitors on a Sunday.

Via [Brian and Carrie](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Michele Venlee](#), [ViaTravelers](#), [One Way Ticket](#), [Jayesh & Shreya](#)

€2 donation

DETAILS

08



Photo: Photo: Andreas Praefcke · CC BY 3.0

Handwerkerhof

BY THE FRAUENTOR, OPPOSITE THE STATION • GREAT FOR KIDS

A craftsmen's courtyard built in 1971 in medieval style, with workshops for glass, leather and tin toys, souvenir shops and small Franconian taverns. Not ancient, but cosy - and at its best at Christmas. One couple found it open Monday to Saturday only (2022).

Via [Prowalk Tours](#), [Rok Goes Around](#), [Near From Home](#), [Tourist Walk Experience](#), [Where Are We?!](#), [Rocky Road 4K](#), [Nicole & Ryan](#), [Así es el mundo](#), [Jazmin Angelique](#)

Free

DETAILS

Toy Museum (Spielzeugmuseum)

OLD TOWN • GREAT FOR KIDS

09

Three floors of Nuremberg's 600 years of toy-making, from antique dolls to model trains and Playmobil, with interactive games. The top rainy-day pick for families.

Via [Rok Goes Around](#), [Así es el mundo](#), [Mita in Germany](#), [Alice & Lucas Travel](#), [Bucket List Urban Adventures](#)

Paid

DETAILS

10



DB Museum

NEAR THE HAUPTBAHNHOF • GREAT FOR KIDS

Germany's oldest railway museum, with around 150 rail vehicles including historic royal carriages – a short walk from St. Lorenz. A reliable hit with train-mad children.

Via [Safari](#), [Alice & Lucas Travel](#), [Mita in Germany](#), [ViaTravelers](#), [Cycle Baba](#)

About €9 (2023)

DETAILS

If you only have one day

ONE

1

The classic loop

- 09:00 **Weißgerbergasse first.** Photograph the tanners' lane before the crowds, then walk up to the castle.
- 10:00 **Kaiserburg.** The free courtyards and views, then the Sinwell Tower and Deep Well demonstration.
- 12:00 **Noon at the Frauenkirche.** Down to the Hauptmarkt for the clock figures at midday, and a spin of the fountain's brass ring.
- 12:30 **Lunch.** Drei im Weggla at the Bratwursthäusle, or a sit-down plate of six at Zum Gulden Stern.
- 14:00 **River & churches.** The Henkersteg, Maxbrücke and Kettensteg, then St. Lorenz.
- 15:30 **Market at dusk.** The lights come on around 4pm: Christkindlesmarkt, Kinderweihnacht and the Sister Cities stalls, with a Feuerzangenbowle or

Kinderpunsch.

18:30

Dinner. Schäufele and a Rotbier flight at Hausbrauerei Altstadt Hof – then back along the lit main streets.

Three days, grouped by area

DAY

1

Old town & castle

- | | |
|-----|---|
| AM | Weißgerbergasse early, then the Kaiserburg, tower and Deep Well. |
| PM | The Pegnitz bridges, St. Lorenz and Lebkuchen Schmidt. |
| EVE | The Christkindlesmarkt at dusk and dinner at Altstadt Hof or Goldenes Posthorn. |
-

DAY

2

Twentieth-century history

- | | |
|-----|---|
| AM | Tram 8 to the Documentation Centre, then the Zeppelinfeld and Great Road (dress for the weather). |
| PM | Memorial Nuremberg Trials and Courtroom 600. |
| EVE | The Market of the Sister Cities and the Jakobsplatz Winter Village. |
-

DAY

3

Families & crafts

AM	The Kinderweihnacht in the morning, when it's calmer, or the Toy Museum if it's wet.
PM	DB Museum, then the Handwerkerhof for wooden toys and a sausage lunch.
EVE	A last look at the market from above - St. Lorenz tower if bookable - and a Feuerzangenbowle by the river.

BRATWURST, LEBKUCHEN AND ROTBIER

Where to eat

Nuremberg's food is small and serious: finger-length sausages grilled over beechwood, three to a roll, and fresh Lebkuchen on a wafer. Every place is credited to the creator who recommended it, and prices carry the year.

Bratwursthäusle

OLD TOWN • BRATWURST HOUSE

€

Sausages grilled over charcoal – sit down for six or more with sauerkraut or potato salad, or order three in a roll at the window (€4 in 2025, card accepted). Where Are We?! rated them far better than stall sausages, and the Schäuferle too.

Family friendly

Via [Where Are We?!](#), [Randy Gamble](#)

VISIT

Zum Gulden Stern

OLD TOWN • HISTORIC BRATWURST KITCHEN

€€

Claims to be one of the oldest bratwurst restaurants (from 1419). Sausages come on a heart-shaped plate with sauerkraut or potato salad; Emeka Iwueze gave it 9.5 out of 10.

Family friendly

Via [Emeka Iwueze](#), [One Way Ticket](#)

VISIT

Hausbrauerei Altstadtthof

BELOW THE CASTLE • BREWPUB

€€

The brewery that helped revive Nuremberg's red beer: try a tasting flight of Rotbier, plus Schäuferle (roast pork shoulder), Rostbratwurst or 'Blaue Zipfel' sausages in vinegar and onion. Seating by the city walls.

Family friendly

Via [Traveling Expats](#), [Near From Home](#), [Cleared 2 Travel](#), [Easy German](#), [A Festival Called Life](#)

VISIT

Goldenes Posthorn

OLD TOWN • FRANCONIAN

€€

Traveling Expats loved the Schäufele with crackling and potato dumplings, and a Sauerbraten with Lebkuchen gravy.

Family friendly

Via [Traveling Expats](#)

VISIT

Bruderhaus Nürnberg

OLD TOWN • FRANCONIAN

€€

Crusty Schäufele in dark beer sauce - you can swap the dumplings for chips - and its own Tucher beer. Very busy in the evening (2026).

Family friendly

Via [Emeka Iwueze Vlogs](#)

VISIT

Albrecht-Dürer-Stuben

NEAR THE CASTLE • FRANCONIAN

€€

An intimate, family-run Franconian restaurant in a 450-year-old building (2022 video).

Family friendly

Via [Wiki Peaks](#)

VISIT

Lebkuchen Schmidt

HAUPTMARKT • LEBKUCHEN SHOP

€

The name creators mention most for Lebkuchen, baked fresh all year. A large fresh one was about €5 in 2024; the tins and chocolate Dominosteine make good gifts. No seating.

Family friendly

Via [Near From Home](#), [Where Are We?!](#), [Traveling Expats](#), [Tourist Walk Tours](#)

VISIT

Wicklein

HAUPTMARKT • LEBKUCHEN SHOP

€

The other classic Lebkuchen maker. A mixed pack was €6.95 in 2024 - about the price of one fresh Lebkuchen.

Family friendly

Via [Where Are We?!](#), [Tourist Walk Tours](#)

VISIT

Schaschlik Wolf

CHRISTKINDLESMARKT • MARKET STALL

€€

A long-running stall with simmered pork skewers in curry-paprika sauce and bread - Here's Good's most memorable bite. €10 plus a €2.50 plate deposit (2025); expect a queue.

Family friendly

Via [Here's Good](#)

VISIT

Egler

CITY CENTRE • SANDWICHES

€€

Toasted scrambled-egg sandwiches - sujuk, bacon and cheese or smoked salmon. Both creators rated them highly; around €10 each in 2024.

Family friendly

Via [Randy Gamble](#), [Niklas Wilson](#)

VISIT

Der Beck

OLD TOWN • BAKERY & CAFÉ

€

A cake-and-coffee stop - the pistachio and marzipan cakes were praised.

Family friendly

Via [Traveling Expats](#)

VISIT

Zeit und Raum

CITY CENTRE • VEGAN CAFÉ

€€

A vegan, regional brunch with breakfast boxes and good cappuccino, also to take away (2022). Useful, because traditional Franconian menus are hard for vegetarians.

Family friendly

Via [deliziös](#), [Near From Home](#)

VISIT

For a grown-ups' drink, it has to be Rotbier: Traveling Expats and Near From Home recommend the tasting flights at Hausbrauerei Altstadtthof, Where Are We?! likes Café Wanderer & Bieramt on a square against the city wall (cash only), and Easy German and Laura Bronner end the rock-cut cellar tour under the castle with a red

beer. At sunset, Traveling Expats says locals sit along the old walls at Albrecht-Dürer-Platz with a drink. Opening times and menus change, so check before you travel. Wiley Fox is not paid for restaurant listings.

BEFORE YOU GO

Getting around Nuremberg

From the airport

The U2 runs from the airport straight to the Hauptbahnhof in about 13 minutes - but only every second U2 goes to the airport, so check the display. Creators found a queue of taxis waiting, so no need to pre-book one.

Via [Jazmin Angelique](#), [EmiLou Day by Day](#)

By train from Munich and beyond

The ICE from Munich is timetabled at about an hour, but one creator's train ran late and took about 1h40; regional trains take about an hour and a half. A Bavaria day ticket for two was €32 in 2025, and a seat reservation on the ICE about €4.90 each way. There are also trains to Stuttgart (a direct one was about €46 in 2024), Frankfurt and Prague, and Cologne is about four hours away. Delays happen, so leave slack for connections.

Via [Jm Banquicio](#), [Jubaer Talukder](#), [Travels & Magic Destinations](#) - [Orion Ember](#), [Travels of Sarah Fay](#), [Ty & Kena](#), [iwannaTV](#)

On foot in the old town

The old town is walkable end to end in about 20 minutes, and maps are posted on street corners. It's cobbled and hilly: one creator's last stretch to her hostel was hard going with a wheeled suitcase, and another's walk from the station to the castle took 30 minutes uphill.

Via [Cleared 2 Travel](#), [Near From Home](#), [Jm Banquicio](#), [Ageless Restyling](#), [Brian and Carrie](#)

U-Bahn and trams

From the Hauptbahnhof it's one stop on the U-Bahn to Lorenzkirche, then about 10 minutes' walk to the castle. Trams run along the line of the old walls and through the medieval gates, and creators found everything punctual. Day tickets are the easy option for more than two trips - see Local tips for current prices.

Via [Jubaer Talukder](#), [Jayesh & Shreya](#), [Sacred Places Journey](#), [Cycle Baba](#)

To the rally grounds

Tram 8 from the station area runs about every 10 minutes and takes around 15 minutes to the Documentation Centre (2023); DW Travel says just under 30 minutes from the city centre, and a local bus

Tourist trains

A tourist train with an audio guide loops past the old-town highlights in about 40 minutes - about €9 in 2022, fun for small children. A 40-minute trolley tour was €10 in 2023, which one couple found steep.

takes about 20. You can rent a bike at the Congress Hall to cover the huge site.

Via [Munich Tour Tips TV](#), [DW Travel](#), [The Iron Armenian](#) aka [G.I. Haigs](#), [Nicole & Ryan](#)

Via [Mita in Germany](#), [Nicole & Ryan](#), [Brian and Carrie](#)

Driving at Christmas

Police ask visitors not to drive to the market on busy weekends and to use public transport instead. No-parking zones keep escape routes clear and illegally parked cars are towed.

Source: Polizeipräsidium Mittelfranken / Stadt Nürnberg reports

Easy day trips

Bamberg, a UNESCO-listed medieval town, is a popular day trip. Closer in, the Faber-Castell pencil factory in Stein is about 30 minutes by U-Bahn (€3.70 single in 2024); its English tour ran about €9 in 2024 and needed booking. The Playmobil FunPark in Zirndorf needed online tickets in advance (2022) and has an indoor area open in winter.

Via [Bucket List Urban Adventures](#), [Apure Gurial](#), [Trailblazin Peppers](#)

What it costs

Day ticket, one person (TagesTicket Solo)	€10.60 Sept 2026
Family day ticket, up to 6 people (TagesTicket Plus)	€15.50 Sept 2026
Nürnberg Card, 48 hours (adult / child 6-11)	€38 / €12 Sept 2026
Glühwein at the market	€5 + €5 mug deposit Nov 2025
Feuerzangenbowle	€6-7 + €3-5 deposit Nov-Dec 2025
Drei im Weggla (three sausages in a roll)	€3.80-4.50 Nov 2025
Fresh Lebkuchen from a market stall	€5.50 Nov 2025
Kaiserburg full ticket	about €9-10 Oct 2025 - Mar 2026

Quick tips

Sights by day, markets by night

In December it's dark by about 3:45-4pm. Do the castle and outdoor sights first and save the markets for when the lights come on.

Wear grippy shoes

Cobbles everywhere, a steep castle hill and wet or icy December pavements. Comfortable, grippy shoes matter more than smart ones.

Look before you eat

Don't settle for the first restaurant on a main square. One creator's traditional schnitzel restaurant opened only at about 4:30pm and booked up quickly.

Two days is about right

Creators range from 24 hours to three days. Two days covers the old town, the castle and the rally grounds without rushing, with evenings at the markets.

Vegetarians: plan ahead

Franconian menus are meat-heavy - Obatzda and Käsespätzle are the usual fall-backs - but the market has a vegetarian and vegan stall, one stall did a vegan Drei im Weggla, and creators found vegan sausages at the Handwerkerhof.

Leave the drone at home

The old town and the market sit inside a no-fly zone for drones, and police enforce a flight ban over the Christkindlesmarkt.

WF

Found a cash-only stall, a broken cash machine or a street that felt wrong? Drop a community report on the map - it helps the next family.

THE SMALL THINGS VISITORS WORRY ABOUT

Local tips for Nuremberg

Every tip here was checked against an official or trusted source (VAG, Deutsche Bahn, christkindlesmarkt.de, nuernberg.de, gov.uk and others) on the date shown. Rules and prices change, so tap the link to double-check before you travel.

Paying for transport

What is the cheapest ticket for one person for a day?

The TagesTicket Solo was 10.60 euros when we checked. It covers unlimited trips on one weekday or weekend day until 3 am the next day, and you can buy it in the NürnbergMOBIL app or at machines.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

What's best for a family of four?

The TagesTicket Plus was 15.50 euros when we checked, and covers 1 to 6 people (max. 2 adults aged 18+) in the Nuremberg-Fürth zone. Great value for families.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Do kids need a ticket on the U-Bahn?

Children aged 6 to 14 pay a kids fare, 1.90 euros for a single (90 minutes, one direction) at time of checking. Buy it in the app or at a machine. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Is the Nürnberg Card worth it?

It costs 38 euros for adults and 12 euros for children aged 6 to 11 (under 6 free) for 48 hours. It includes public transport in the region and 30+ museums, including the Imperial Castle, so it pays off if you do several sights. Prices were current when we checked. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

How do I get from the airport to the centre?

Take the U2 straight to the Hauptbahnhof, about 13 minutes. Note that only every second U2 goes to the airport, so check the display before boarding. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Should I buy a Deutschlandticket for a short trip?

Probably not. It is 63 euros a month and sold as a monthly subscription, cancellable by the 10th, so day tickets are simpler for a short break. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Is the U-Bahn at Lorenzkirche step-free?*

Not fully. The lift there reaches only the underground passage, not street level. Hauptbahnhof and Weisser Turm are better if you have a pushchair or wheelchair.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Water & snacks

Is the tap water safe to drink?

Yes. N-ERGIE says Nuremberg's tap water can be drunk without hesitation, even for baby formula, so fill your bottle at the hotel tap and save a few euros. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

What is the bottle deposit thing on drinks?

Most plastic bottles and cans carry a 25 cent Pfand. Take them back to any shop that sells drinks, usually to the machine near the entrance, and keep the receipt to use at the till. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Are glass bottles charged a deposit too?

Yes. Reusable glass bottles usually carry 8 to 15 cents, and shops may only take back their own brands. Easiest is to return them where you bought them. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Do I pay extra for my Glühwein mug?*

Yes, there is a mug deposit (Pfand). It was 5 euros at the 2025 market, so expect something similar and check the amount at the stall. Hand the mug back to any stall to get your deposit back. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Toilets

CHRISTMAS *Where are the toilets at the Christmas market?*

Public toilets are in the Rathaus (about 50 cents) and a paid toilet wagon stands on Obstmarkt near the Frauenkirche. The

CHRISTMAS *Is there an accessible toilet near the market?*

Yes, there is an accessible toilet on the west side of the Rathaus, just north of the Christkindlesmarkt. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

market FAQ also points to toilets behind the Frauenkirche, so have coins ready.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

CHRISTMAS *Will I need coins for public toilets?*

Often, yes. Public toilets at the Christmas market are pay-to-use, so keep a few small coins in your pocket, especially with children. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Parks & play

Where can the kids let off steam in town?

VAG lists central playgrounds such as Veit-Stoss-Platz (U1 Gostenhof), the Annapark with a water play area (U1 Maffeiplatz) and Luitpoldhain with a zip line (bus 45/65).

Checked 2026-09 ↗

CHRISTMAS *Is there something for kids at the Christmas market?*

The Kinderweihnacht on Hans-Sachs-Platz has a carousel, steam train and mini Ferris wheel. The Christkind visits Tuesday to Friday at 14:30. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

What can we do with kids on a wet day?

The tourist board suggests the Toy Museum, Planetarium, Playmobil FunPark and the Zoo. A free children's city map is available at tourist information centres and hotels. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Money & tipping

How much should I tip in restaurants?

CHRISTMAS *Can I pay by card at the Christmas market?*

Around 5 to 10 percent, or just round up. Tell the server the total you want to pay when settling up rather than leaving coins on the table. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Stalls generally accept cash and cards, but not every stall does. Bring some euro notes and coins as a back-up, and use the cash for small snacks and the mug deposit.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Phones & data

Will my UK phone roam for free in Germany?

Not automatically. Since Brexit UK networks are not legally required to offer free EU roaming, so check your plan before you fly, or buy a roaming pass. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Will I get a warning if roaming costs add up?

Ofcom rules in force since 1 October 2024 require UK providers to alert you when you connect abroad and when you approach or pass a spending limit. Still set a limit and switch roaming off for the kids' phones.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Should I get an eSIM or local SIM?

Ofcom lists a local or virtual SIM as a way to cut costs. Compare with your own network's day pass, and use hotel Wi-Fi for maps and downloads. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Safety habits

What number do I ring in an emergency?

112 for fire, ambulance and general emergencies and 110 for police. Both are free from any phone. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Do I have to carry my passport?

There is no legal requirement to carry ID in Germany, but if police ask and you cannot show it, they can escort you to fetch your passport. A photo of it on your phone helps but is not a substitute. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Is pickpocketing a worry?*

Crime levels are similar to the UK, but gov.uk urges vigilance at airports, stations and crowded places, and not leaving bags unattended. Keep bags zipped in Christmas market crowds. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

How do I check if an area feels right after dark?

Before heading out, look up the area in the Wiley Fox app (www.thewileyfox.com) alongside asking your hotel, then stay on lit main routes. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Local ways

Are shops open on Sundays?

No. In Bavaria shops must close all day on Sundays and holidays, and after 20:00 on weekdays, with exceptions for pharmacies, bakeries and small unmanned mini-markets. Stock up on Saturday. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Is the Kaiserburg open when I visit?

Daily 9 to 18 (April to September) and 10 to 16 (October to March), closed 1 Jan, Shrove Tuesday and 24, 25 and 31 December. Last entry is about an hour before closing.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Can we see the castle's Deep Well?

Yes, but only on a guided tour, which is included with admission. The Palas audio guide costs 2 euros per person.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *When does the Christmas market run in 2026?*

27 November to 24 December, daily 10:00 to 21:00, with the opening ceremony at 17:30 on 27 November. Always double-check on christkindlesmarkt.de.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Is the Sister Cities market worth a visit?*

Yes. Stalls from Glasgow, Verona, Nice, Atlanta and more are on Rathausplatz, 27 November to 23 December 2026.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Is the market OK with pushchairs and dogs?*

Dogs are not banned, but crowds make it hard. The cobbles and high stall counters mean access is a bit limited, so allow extra time and avoid peak evenings.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

What are the passport rules for UK visitors?

Gov.uk says your passport must be under 10 years old on arrival and valid at least 3 months after you leave the Schengen area. You can visit visa-free for up to 90 days in any 180. The gov.uk entry page did not mention ETIAS when we checked.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Travel with Wiley Fox

Official travel advice for 200+ countries, community reports, one-tap SOS, and QR wristbands so lost children and lost bags find their way back.

Our sources

This guide summarises these creators' videos in our own words. Watch the originals - they are worth it. Crime data: Polizeipräsidium Mittelfranken, Sicherheitsbericht 2025 (PKS) (Jan 2025 to Dec 2025). City-level annual police statistics for Nuremberg in 2025, plus Nuremberg police press releases on the Christkindlesmarkt in 2024 and 2025 and the City of Nuremberg's 2025 security report. No street-level or district crime data is published, and rates are per resident, not adjusted for visitors.

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A Festival Called Life · 2026-03
2. [Exploring the Nuremberg Christmas Market - Travel Vlog | Is it the best Christmas Market in Europe??](#)
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5. [NUREMBERG CHRISTMAS MARKETS](#)
Andrew & Kait · 2023-12
6. [A CIDADE MAIS BONITA DA ALEMANHA? O que fazer em Nuremberg, roteiro completo e tour FABER CASTELL](#)
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